Student Behavior & Discipline Published July 2026

Disciplinary Measures

The approach of the school to discipline has always been preventive and formative. It is not punitive but rather educative.

A comprehensive and intense information campaign is initiated during the first few days of classes to ensure that all school rules and policies are communicated and understood by all concerned.

Another preventive measure that the school can implement to ensure students' safety is to conduct a bag search by the Discipline Officer, or in their absence, by the School Administrator.

A detailed warning system is in place for minor offenses. However, should all preventive measures and mechanisms fail, the school, through proper authorities, applies disciplinary measures or actions.

Disciplinary measures or actions are meant to teach students the principles and ideals of justice to help them achieve self-discipline, as well as to enjoin them in developing and sustaining an atmosphere conducive to learning.

Corrective Actions to Minor and Major Offenses

Corrective Actions are disciplinary measures that are imposed corresponding to the severity of the offense/s done by an erring student.

Verbal/Oral Warning

A Verbal/Oral warning is a disciplinary measure given to a student who has committed minor violations. This is to call the attention of the student that they have not observed the appropriate behavior expected of them. It is a reminder or reprimand to a student who committed a minor offense for the first time. This shall be included on the student's record since this shall be considered an initial warning.

Written Apology

A Written Apology is a corrective action in which a student is required to write a letter of apology. This is imposed on a case-to-case basis and shall be included on the student's record.

Written Reprimand

A Written Reprimand is a corrective action that is issued by the Discipline Committee. The student is given a formal letter or notice of any violation of the school rules and regulations. The student-specific misbehavior, together with the original copy of the written reprimand form, is put on the student's record.

Corrective Reinforcement

During the period of corrective reinforcement, the student is still allowed to attend their classes. However, they have to be scheduled for one-on-one session after their last class period and to accomplish tasks as determined and given by the assigned person-in-authority of the Discipline Committee. The tasks under this sanction must help the student reflect and avoid repetition of the violated offense. The corrective reinforcement will be lifted a day after the specified date of rendering the sanction and after the completion of the task from a person-in-authority assigned by the Discipline Committee.

Conference with the Discipline Committee

The parents/guardians are called for a conference with the Discipline Committee, Program Head, and/or Guidance Counselor for them to discuss the offense and the corresponding course of action to avoid the recurrence of the offense. This is required to be done to cases with the following sanctions: Written Apology, Written Reprimand, Corrective Reinforcement, Suspension, Non-readmission, Exclusion, and Expulsion.

Categories of Disciplinary Administrative Penalties

According to the provisions in the 2008 Manual of Regulations for Private Higher Education (MORPHE), the four (4) categories of disciplinary administrative penalties for serious offenses of school rules and regulations which may be applied to an erring student are:

Suspension

In STI, this sanction has two (2) types:

a. Suspension from class

It is a penalty that excludes the offender from regular classwork and from other privileges or activities for a definite period of time. This is to be served within a reasonable time from the issuance of the decision of the Discipline Committee. A student under suspension is still required to report to school from 8 am to 5 pm but is not allowed to join their classes. They are required to do the task to be determined and supervised by the assigned person-in-authority of the Discipline Committee. The tasks under this sanction must help the student reflect and avoid repetition of the violated offense. Although they will be re-admitted to school, the suspension shall be put on the student's record. The suspension is imposed only after the parents or guardians have been informed through writing and invited to a conference with the Discipline Committee.

b. Preventive Suspension

A student under investigation may be preventively suspended from entering the school premises and from attending classes, when the evidence of guilt is strong and the responsible school official is morally convinced that the continued stay of the student during the period of the investigation constitutes a distraction to the normal operations of the school or poses a risk or danger to the life of persons and property in the school. The school is allowed to impose this sanction for a period not exceeding 20% of the prescribed class days for the school term. The suspension is imposed only after the parents or guardians have been informed through writing and conference with the Discipline Committee.

Non-readmission

Non-readmission is a penalty in which the school is allowed to deny admission or enrollment of an erring student for the school term immediately following the term when the resolution or decision finding the student guilty of the offense charged and imposing the penalty of non-readmission was promulgated. Unlike the penalty of exclusion, the student is allowed to complete the current school term when the resolution of non-readmission was promulgated. Transfer Credentials of the erring student shall be issued upon promulgation, subject to the other provisions stated in the MORPHE.

Exclusion

Exclusion is a penalty in which the school is allowed to exclude or drop the name of the erring student from the roll of students immediately upon resolution for exclusion was promulgated. This penalty may be imposed for acts or offenses such as dishonesty, hazing, carrying deadly weapons, immorality, selling and/or possession of prohibited drugs, drug dependency, drunkenness, hooliganism, vandalism, and other offenses analogous to the foregoing. Transfer Credentials of the erring student shall be issued upon promulgation, subject to the provisions stated in the MORPHE.

The school shall preserve a complete record of the proceedings for a period of one (1) year in order to afford the Discipline Committee and Commission on Higher Education (CHED) the opportunity to review the case in the event the student makes and files an appeal with the CHED.

Expulsion

Expulsion is a penalty in which an institution declares an erring student disqualified for admission to any public or private higher education institution in the Philippines. In any case, the penalty of expulsion cannot be imposed without the approval of the CHED Chairperson. This penalty may be imposed for acts or offenses involving moral turpitude or constituting gross misconduct, which are considered criminal pursuant to existing penal laws.

The institution shall forward a complete record of the proceedings to the CHED Regional Office concerned within 10 days from the termination of the investigation of each case.

Imposition of sanctions cited in this handbook shall not in any way prejudice the filing of cases in and the implementation of penalties prescribed by a court of law.

Also, in cases that involve significant damage or destruction of property, the Discipline Committee will decide whether the recipient of the sanction will replace the destroyed, damaged, or lost property. For cases of cheating in an examination or other school activities, a failing grade shall be given in the particular examination or activity.

All sanctions shall go along with a one-on-one session with the School's Guidance Counselor or Associate.

© 2026 STI Student Handbook - Tertiary

This handbook is subject to regular review. The version issued by STI is authoritative.